

Table 6.1.15 : Distribution of Population by Religion and District, 2024

District	Religion						
	Total	Buddhist	Hindu	Islam	Roman Catholic	Other Christian	Other
Sri Lanka	21,781,800	15,199,093	2,734,839	2,337,379	1,224,348	282,185	3,956
Colombo	2,375,415	1,682,524	197,759	298,422	139,882	55,624	1,204
Gampaha	2,436,142	1,744,475	69,429	134,422	442,291	44,540	985
Kalutara	1,305,784	1,080,638	42,528	138,230	36,510	7,733	145
Kandy	1,461,895	1,063,511	144,618	223,997	18,623	10,919	227
Matale	526,870	418,608	46,181	52,224	7,797	2,026	34
Nuwara Eliya	725,280	278,828	377,266	21,929	31,705	15,474	78
Galle	1,097,372	1,026,031	15,600	46,038	4,207	5,377	119
Matara	837,889	787,303	14,625	29,858	2,445	3,619	39
Hambantota	671,418	649,736	1,401	17,947	1,017	1,247	70
Jaffna	594,751	2,788	489,521	4,352	77,197	20,857	36
Mannar	123,756	382	26,214	33,883	57,713	5,560	4
Vavuniya	172,312	18,292	114,504	17,775	12,785	8,895	61
Mullaitivu	122,619	10,293	88,738	3,279	13,982	6,315	12
Kilinochchi	136,710	1,533	110,258	1,394	14,446	9,074	5
Batticaloa	595,918	6,024	374,836	161,494	25,803	27,728	33
Ampara	744,551	276,176	114,586	339,896	7,351	6,486	56
Trincomalee	442,745	106,919	108,050	205,664	14,353	7,714	45
Kurunegala	1,768,156	1,557,554	17,487	143,299	40,273	9,413	130
Puttalam	818,816	361,148	28,832	176,963	240,975	10,619	279
Anuradhapura	960,080	862,807	3,755	83,979	5,760	3,656	123
Polonnaruwa	447,530	399,488	7,215	37,097	2,560	1,086	84
Badulla	872,307	636,988	166,380	53,563	9,593	5,729	54
Moneragala	527,585	498,436	14,974	12,262	1,181	713	19
Ratnapura	1,145,423	999,682	103,883	26,796	8,607	6,394	61
Kegalle	870,476	728,929	56,199	72,616	7,292	5,387	53

According to the census 2024 data, as presented in Table 6.1.15, the total Buddhist community reported as 15,199,093 and its highest concentration reported in Gampaha (1,744,475), Colombo (1,682,524), and Kurunegala (1,557,554) districts. The Hindu population consists of 2,734,839 individuals, primarily distributed across Jaffna (489,521), Nuwara Eliya (377,266), and Batticaloa (374,836) districts. The total number of Islamic adherents is 2,337,379, with the highest concentrations found in the Ampara (339,896), Colombo (298,422), and Kandy (223,997) districts. Roman Catholics are most widely distributed in the Gampaha (442,291), Puttalam (240,975), and Colombo (139,882) districts. Additionally, the highest populations belonging to other Christian denominations are reported in the Colombo and Gampaha districts.